

The first 30 days

How to get seen by the people who can hire you, starting from nobody knowing your name. Written for someone who wants a job, not customers.

What this can and cannot do

Most LinkedIn advice is written for founders and executives. Two of the biggest levers in that world are publishing a role with the salary attached, and timing a launch. You have neither. If a guide tells you to post your funding round, it was not written for you.

What follows is the part that transfers, plus the two plays that replace the ones you cannot run. I write LinkedIn content for B2B executives every day, so the patterns here come from watching a lot of first months up close, and from running one myself.

The honest promise. Cadence above three posts a week, the four post shapes below, and twenty minutes a day in other people's comments will beat your own baseline by a multiple you can measure. Whether that multiple reaches six figures depends on what you have to say and who already knows you. I am not going to pretend otherwise.

1. Before you post anything

The positioning line

One sentence: who you are for, and what you do for them. Not your job title. If your line could appear on three hundred other profiles, it is not a line, it is a category.

Write it, then write the things you will never post about. The second list matters more. A feed that is about four things is about nothing.

The profile rebuild

Do this before the first post, because week one is when traffic actually arrives and a good post pointing at a dead profile wastes the post.

Headline: what you do for whom, not the title your payroll system uses. **About:** first two lines carry it, everything after is collapsed behind a "see more" nobody clicks. **Featured:** two or three links maximum, each one something a hiring manager can open and judge in thirty seconds.

2. The four posts that do the work

PLAY ONE

The introduction

Who you are, what you are going to write about, and what you have actually done. Publish it first.

Why it works: an account with no posting history gets an outsized first push, and an introduction is the one post where talking about yourself is the point. In the launches I have measured, the introduction post regularly out-reaches everything published in the month after it, and produces the highest engagement rate of the entire window. Specifics carry it. A concrete career fact beats a general hello every time.

PLAY TWO

The teardown

Pick a company you would want to work for, or a problem in your field, and do the work in public. What is broken, what you would change, what you would measure. Name the company. Be generous rather than clever.

Why it works: this is the play that replaces the hiring post, and it is the strongest one you have. It gets forwarded, because it is useful to someone other than you. It proves capability instead of claiming it. And it reaches the exact people who could hire you, doing the exact job you want, before anyone has agreed to interview you. This is the same move as a good cold message, run in public and at scale.

PLAY THREE

The receipt

One number from your own work, and the story of how it happened. What the situation was, what you tried, what broke, what it ended at.

Why it works: a number is the only thing in a feed that cannot be rewritten by someone with a better vocabulary. It also does the work an interview usually does, which means the conversation starts further along.

PLAY FOUR

The story only you can tell

The job you left and why. The thing you got badly wrong. The decision nobody else in your feed had to make.

Why it works: lowest reach, highest engagement, every time. These posts are not supposed to win the month. They are what turns the people who saw the teardown into people who come back, which is the difference between a spike and an audience.

3. The thirty days, week by week

Three posts a week, on the same three days. Cadence matters more than timing, and both matter less than having something worth publishing.

WEEK ONE

Establish who you are

Profile rewritten first. Then the introduction post, one view you can defend, and one receipt.

WEEK TWO

Do the work in public

The teardown. This is the week reach usually arrives, and the week the right people start reading.

WEEK THREE

Earn the audience

The stories only you can tell. Low reach, high engagement, and the posts that turn visitors into followers.

WEEK FOUR

Convert

A second teardown, and the DMs. By now people have context on you, so the message is a continuation rather than an interruption.

4. The formatting floor

These decide your reach before anyone has read a word, and every one of them is a formatting decision rather than a writing one. They are correlations observed across large samples of LinkedIn posts, not published platform rules, and they move every few months.

LEVER	TARGET	OBSERVED EFFECT
Character count	1,250 to 3,000	+31% reach
Paragraph count	14 or more	under 7 costs most of your reach
Average word length	5 letters or fewer	longer costs about 40%
Hashtags	None	three or more costs most of your reach
External links	1 to 3	+43% reach
Images	1200 x 1500, portrait	+47% over landscape
Carousels and infographics	Where they fit	around 3x a plain text post
Closing line	A statement, or a question answerable in one sentence	generic questions do worse than no question
Topic	Career and how work actually works	the most reliably shared category

Treat these as a floor, not a formula. They stop a good post being invisible. They will not make a boring one interesting.

5. The part nobody does

Commenting is the highest leverage unpaid thing on the platform and almost nobody does it properly. Accounts in the top one percent leave well over a hundred replies a week on other people's posts. The average account leaves a third of that, and the relationship between comment volume and follower growth is one of the strongest in the data.

Ten to twenty comments a day, on posts the people who hire you already read. Lead with your own experience, never with praise. It takes twenty minutes and it does more for your distribution than a fourth weekly post would.

If you only do one thing: this. It works in week one, it needs no audience, and it puts you in front of exactly the right people while your own posts are still finding their feet.

6. What good looks like at day 30

You have a profile that explains you in one line. Twelve posts up, four of them teardowns and receipts. A comment habit that runs on its own. And a short list of people who have seen your name enough times that a message from you is not cold any more.

That last one is the entire point. Everything above exists so that the message you send on day 31 gets read.